

THE NEWS LOCKOUT

For a few minutes a day, levels stop working. Those minutes are printed in advance.

Gold's worst beginner losses happen at a known minute, on a chart that looked fine. This snippet explains what the market actually does at a release, and the rule we hold around it.

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LENGTH

4 pages

LEVEL

Beginner

RECORD

Reviewed by Sam

⚠ Trading gold, forex and CFDs on margin carries a high level of risk and you could lose more than your initial deposit. 70–80% of retail investor accounts lose money when trading CFDs. Past performance is not indicative of future results. All content is for education only and is not financial advice.

WHAT A RELEASE DOES TO THE BOOK

A high-impact number does not simply move price. It empties the market first. In the minutes before the print, liquidity providers pull their quotes because nobody wants to be the one holding the wrong side of a surprise.

Three things follow, in order, every time.

WHAT HAPPENS	WHAT IT COSTS YOU
The spread widens	Your cost to be in the trade multiplies for as long as the thin book lasts.
Price gaps instead of walking	With nothing resting in between, gold prints one level then another, with no chance to react.
Stops fill at worse prices	Slippage. Your stop is an instruction to exit, not a promise about the price you get.

YOUR LEVEL DID NOT FAIL

For those minutes the market simply stopped quoting it. No amount of chart reading solves that — which is why the answer is a clock, not an indicator.

THE RULE, AND WHAT IT COSTS

One window, held without debate. Times are the release time on your calendar, in MYT.

CLOCK	WHAT YOU DO
T-30	No new entries. Open trades go to breakeven, or get closed if the stop sits inside the noise.
T-0	Release. Hands off the mouse. Whatever the first candle does is not a signal.
T+15	Re-mark, then re-enter. The spread is back and the new range is visible. Old levels may have to be redrawn.

Which releases earn the window: US inflation data, the Fed rate decision and its press conference, and the monthly jobs report — plus anything your calendar marks high impact for the dollar. Three or four dates a month, every one published weeks ahead.

WHAT THE LOCKOUT COSTS

It is not free, and pretending otherwise would be dishonest. Some of the cleanest runs of the month start on a release, and the lockout means we watch them from outside.

-1R on a stopped-out trade before a print, while price later ran to TP2 without us, is the shape that cost takes. It gets published like everything else. We still hold the rule, because the alternative is a stop that means nothing on the days that matter most.

NEXT

THREE THINGS TO DO THIS WEEK

1. List this week's high-impact US releases in MYT. Set an alarm 30 minutes before each one.
2. Watch one release without a position open. Note the spread before, during and 15 minutes after.
3. Check your last three worst losses against the calendar. Count how many landed in a lockout window.

SUNDAY JOB, FIVE MINUTES

Write the week's high-impact releases into your journal in MYT before Monday. The lockout only works if you know the minute before the day starts.

WHERE THE SIGNALS LIVE

Lockout windows are announced before they open, and the trades skipped because of them are named in the record.

Open the bot →

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